MEMORANDUM TO THE FILE

-Subject: Rauwolfia

In a conversation at with and in connection with ARTICHOKE and other matters, the conversation at one time turned to the matter of Rauwolfia. remarked something to the effect that Rauwolfia had a strong potentiating effect in connection with alcohol or when used with alcohol. so far as the writer remembers attributed this to

31 January 1955

SUBJECT: Rauwolfia Serpentina

This is a native Indian plant which has remarkable psychogenic qualities. Many United States chemical houses including Squibb and Ciba are attempting to bring out chemical extracts from this plant or to synthesize the drug. Some of the brade names being used are Reserpin and Serpasil.

The drug apparently has amazing, relaxing, sedative qualities. It is reported that in animals it will convert a violently aggressive dangerous condition to a completely docile one. It is reported that dangerous apes have been rendered harmless in very short periods of time by use of this drug. There is however very little information on its use or [redacted] although there is probably some information available in India in this connection.

dangers in humans

A [redacted] and [redacted] are examining available material

A on this and [redacted] will check this out at the Amer Psychiatric Assn Convention at St Louis 3-7 May 54.